STATE OF WASHINGTON
DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL AND HEALTH SERVICES
COMMUNITY SERVICES DIVISION
Economic Services Administration
Post Office Box 45440 Olympia WA 98504-5440

Dec. 26, 2024

Dear interested parties and community partners,

Congress passed the Continuing Appropriations and Extensions Act, 2025, on Sept. 26, 2024, which extended the replacements authorized in the Consolidated Appropriations Act, 2023. The act required states to replace food benefits stolen between Oct. 1, 2022, and Dec. 20, 2024, via card skimming, card cloning and other similar, fraudulent methods.

As of today's date, Congress did not extend the date to replace these benefits. Based on current guidance, food benefits stolen on or after Dec. 21, 2024, cannot be replaced.

Cash replacements will also end, as rules authorized under ESSB 5950 to replace Temporary Assistance for Needy Families, State Family Assistance, Pregnant Women's Assistance, Refugee Cash Assistance and Aged, Blind or Disabled cash benefits stolen July 1, 2024, or later mirror the end date for food replacements.

The department will deny any claims for benefits that are stolen on or after Dec. 21, 2024. This change does not affect claims for benefits stolen on or before Dec. 20, 2024; we will continue to process these claims if reported within 30 days of discovery, even if the date of discovery is after Dec. 20, 2024.

We're notifying clients about the conclusion of benefit replacement via:

- Social media.
- Call center hold messaging.
- DSHS webpages.

Please feel free to share this information with our constituents.

If you have any questions, please contact Sharon Hill-Laguerre, Basic Food Policy administrator, at sharon.hill-laguerre@dshs.wa.gov.

Your ongoing support is appreciated.

Sincerely,

Brice Montgomery, Interim Director
Community Services Division

DSHS: *Partnering with People*